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Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250270872

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

August 28, 2025

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FENESTRATION UNIT WITH INTERIOR INSTALLATION FEATURES AND ASSOCIATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS

Abstract

Installation systems and methods for fenestration units configured to be set into a rough opening from an interior side of a building or wall. The fenestration units may include a retention system coupled to the frame and operable to exert a retention force on the fenestration unit to maintain positive engagement of the fenestration unit with the rough opening framing and resist extraction of the fenestration unit from the rough opening upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening from the interior side of the rough opening.

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Appl. No.: 19/057850

Filed: February 19, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63557037 20240223

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: E06B1/60 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/557,037, entitled “FENESTRATION UNIT WITH INTERIOR INSTALLATION FEATURES AND ASSOCIATED SYSTEMS AND METHODS”, filed Feb. 23, 2024, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Window designs typically have an exterior nailing flange and are installed from the exterior side of the building envelope. Two installers work together, one on the interior and the other on the exterior. Some installation crews have determined it is easier to unpackage the window inside the building where it is relatively clean and flat. Then they pass the window through the rough opening to a person on the exterior side. In some instances, the person on the exterior side is on a ladder which can substantially complicate installation. The installer on the interior side centers the window in the rough opening and inserts shims to level, plumb and square all while the exterior installer is holding the window. After the window is correctly set, the interior installer holds the window in place while the exterior installer drives nails or screws through the exterior nailing flange to anchor it. If it is a venting window, the sash is then opened to check functional operation. The interior installer proceeds to inject expansion foam around the perimeter of the window in the gap between the frame and rough opening to create the interior air seal. At the same time, the exterior installer applies 3 to 4 inches wide flashing tape on the jambs and across the head of the window.

BACKGROUND PATENTS

TABLE-US-00001 Patent Number Title Filing Date U.S. Pat. No. 8,621,795 Fenestration frame with bonded support 2011 Apr. 20 brackets . . . U.S. Pat. No. 8,109,052 Monolithic fenestration construction 2009 May 21 member . . . U.S. Pat. No. 7,162,841 Spring clip and method of window 2004 Feb. 13 installation DE 2020 16101375 Supporting and fastening 2016 Mar. 11 window . . . to . . . wall opening WO 2015/142201 Mounting, sealing and thermal insulation 2014 Sep. 5 of windows . . . U.S. Pat. No. 6,293,061 System and method for installing a jamb 1999 Sep. 30 U.S. Pat. No. 5,692,350 Apparatus and method for leveling 1996 Feb. 2 closures U.S. Pat. No. 11,332,946 Installation features for fenestration 2019 Jul. 25 units . . . U.S. Pat. No. 8,006,445 Self-sealing window installation and 2008 Jan. 15 method U.S. 2008/0127564 Pre-hung door assembly and method of 2008 Jan. 18 installation U.S. Pat. No. 10,895,099 Support bracket for window 2016 Aug. 23 installation . . . U.S. 2005/0262782 Self-Flashing Assembly 2004 Jun. 1 U.S. 2020/0318418 Fenestration assembly and installation 2020 Apr. 2 system for the same U.S. Pat. No. 4,488,391 Centering clips for window frames 1980 Dec. 17 U.S. 2011/0258947 Fenestration frame with bonded support 2011 Apr. 20 brackets and methods of making same

BACKGROUND PRODUCTS

[0003] Innotech Windows & Doors, Strap Anchors [0004] <https://www.innotech-windows.com/blog/in-depth-benefits-of-anchoring-method-window-installation> [0005] FrontLine Tru-Loc™ Brackets [0006] <https://frontlinebldg.com/all-products/accessories/tru-loc-window-door-installation-anchor/> [0007] Amesbury Hinged Fin [0008] <https://www.amesburytruth.com/products/extrusions/nailing-fin/hinged/hinged-pp>**1219**

SUMMARY

[0009] Various advantages may be achieved according to the example systems and methods described herein. The various examples may be one or more of: more efficient (e.g., cycle time reduced by 50% or more); easier to learn; easier to remember; easier to train; may be less

physically demanding (e.g., window is not set from the exterior side which could be on uneven ground or require a ladder); window is unable to fall out toward exterior during installation; can be installed by a single person from the interior of the building or wall; interior and exterior installation tasks do not need to be done simultaneously; improved fenestration install quality and fenestration performance following installation; delivers an installation method that is unique to the industry and offers many benefits for the installer; faster cycle times; improved performance (water and air infiltration); adapts to wall depth variation; simplifies casing installation for finish carpenters; separates interior and exterior work so they can be done “independently”.

Install Brackets—Device

[0010] According to one embodiment (“Embodiment 1”), a fenestration unit is configured for installation in a rough opening in a structure defined by rough opening framing. The rough opening framing has an interior face and an exterior face opposite the interior face. The fenestration unit includes a frame having a channel and a plurality of mounting brackets configured to be secured to the frame. The plurality of mounting brackets include a first mounting bracket, and the first mounting bracket includes a first leg including a foot configured to be received in the channel to secure the first mounting bracket to the frame, and a second leg coupled to the first leg. The second leg is angularly offset from the first leg and configured to abut the interior face of the rough opening framing.

[0011] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 2”), further to Embodiment 1, the frame further includes a sidewall defining the channel, the sidewall including a slot, and the foot being received in the slot.

[0012] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 3”), further to any of Embodiments 1-2, the foot includes an ankle portion coupled to an angled toe portion.

[0013] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 4”), further to any of Embodiments 1-3, the frame further includes a sidewall defining the channel, the sidewall including a slot, and the toe portion being received in the slot.

[0014] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 5”), further to any of Embodiments 1-4, the foot further includes a claw extending from the toe portion.

[0015] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 6”), further to any of Embodiments 1-5, further including an installation stabilizer system coupled to the frame and operable to exert a retention force on the rough opening framing to maintain positive engagement of the fenestration unit with the rough opening framing and resist extraction of the fenestration unit from the rough opening upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening.

[0016] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 7”), further to any of Embodiments 1-6, the first leg is integrally formed with the second leg.

[0017] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 8”), further to any of Embodiments 1-7, the frame further includes a sill, and further including a sill spacer coupled to the sill and configured to abut the rough opening framing.

[0018] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 9”), further to any of Embodiments 1-8, further including a fin assembly coupled to the frame, the fin assembly configured to transition from a first, stowed configuration in which the fin assembly projects in a direction of a front of the frame and a second, deployed configuration in which the fin assembly projects outward relative to the frame.

[0019] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 10”), further to any of Embodiments 1-9, the frame further includes an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior surface, the channel being disposed on the perimeter.

[0020] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 11”), further to any of Embodiments 1-10, the foot is a first foot and the first leg further includes a second foot configured to be removably received in the channel to secure the first mounting bracket to the frame.

[0021] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 12”), further to any of Embodiments 1-11, the second leg includes an aperture configured to receive a fastener for securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing.

[0022] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 13”), further to any of Embodiments 1-12, the frame further includes an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior surface, the channel being disposed on the interior surface.

[0023] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 14”), further to any of Embodiments 1-13, the channel is a first channel, the frame further includes a second channel being disposed on the perimeter, and the first leg further includes a second foot configured to be removably received in the second channel to secure the first mounting bracket to the frame.

[0024] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 15”), further to any of Embodiments 1-14, the first channel is an accessory channel, the second channel is an installation fin channel, and further including an installation fin assembly disposed in the installation fin channel.

[0025] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 16”), further to any of Embodiments 1-15, the second leg includes an aperture configured to receive a fastener for securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing.

[0026] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 17”), further to any of Embodiments 1-16, the mounting bracket further includes an installation stabilizer system operable to exert a retention force on the rough opening framing to maintain positive engagement of the fenestration unit with the rough opening framing and resist extraction of the fenestration unit from the rough opening upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening.

[0027] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 18”), further to any of Embodiments 1-17, the first mounting bracket includes actuator being actuatable to couple the first mounting bracket to the frame.

[0028] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 19”), further to any of Embodiments 1-18, the actuator is actuatable to move the foot into the channel and thereby couple the first mounting bracket to the frame.

[0029] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 20”), further to any of Embodiments 1-19, the actuator includes a pivotable lever.

[0030] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 21”), further to any of Embodiments 1-20, further including a coupling bracket configured to be secured to the frame, wherein the coupling bracket includes an aperture configured to receive a fastener for securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing.

Install Brackets—Method of Installation

[0031] According to one embodiment (“Embodiment 1”), a method of installing a fenestration unit in a rough opening in a structure defined by rough opening framing, the rough opening framing having an interior face and an exterior face opposite the interior face, includes: coupling a first mounting bracket to a frame of the fenestration unit by positioning a foot of a first leg of the first mounting bracket in a channel of the frame; seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening by together translating the frame and the first mounting bracket in an exterior direction within the rough opening until a second leg of the first mounting bracket angularly offset from the first leg is abutted against the interior face of the rough opening framing; and securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing.

[0032] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 2”), further to Embodiment 1, the frame further includes a sidewall defining the channel, the sidewall including a slot, and positioning the foot of the first mounting bracket in the channel includes positioning the foot in the slot.

[0033] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 3”), further to any of Embodiments 1-2, the foot includes an ankle portion coupled an angled toe portion, and positioning the foot of the first mounting bracket in the channel includes positioning the angled toe portion in the slot.

[0034] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 4”), further to any of Embodiments 1-3, further including forming the slot in the sidewall at a predetermined location on the frame, and thereafter positioning the foot of the first mounting bracket in the slot.

[0035] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 5”), further to any of Embodiments 1-4, forming the slot in the sidewall at the predetermined location on the frame is performed in a manufacturing setting, and positioning the foot of the first mounting bracket in the slot is performed in an installation setting.

[0036] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 6”), further to any of Embodiments 1-5, seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening further includes abutting an installation stabilizer system coupled to the fenestration unit against the rough opening framing such that the installation stabilizer system exerts a retention force on the rough opening framing to retain the fenestration unit in the rough opening and prevent tipping of the fenestration unit in an interior direction opposite the exterior direction.

[0037] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 7”), further to any of Embodiments 1-6, seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening further includes abutting a sill spacer coupled to a bottom of the frame against the rough opening framing.

[0038] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 8”), further to any of Embodiments 1-7, further including deploying a fin assembly coupled to the frame from a first, stowed configuration in which the fin assembly projects in the exterior direction to a second, deployed configuration in which the fin assembly projects outward relative to the frame.

[0039] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 9”), further to any of Embodiments 1-8, the second leg includes an aperture, and wherein securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing includes inserting a fastener in the aperture.

[0040] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 10”), further to any of Embodiments 1-9, the frame further includes an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior surface, the channel being disposed on the interior surface.

[0041] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 11”), further to any of Embodiments 1-10, the frame further includes an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior surface, the channel being disposed on the perimeter.

[0042] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 12”), further to any of Embodiments 1-11, seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening further includes abutting an installation stabilizer system coupled to the first mounting bracket against the rough opening framing such that the installation stabilizer system exerts a retention force on the rough opening framing to retain the fenestration unit in the rough opening and prevent tipping of the fenestration unit in an interior direction opposite the exterior direction.

[0043] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 13”), further to any of Embodiments 1-12, securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing includes installing a fastener through a coupling bracket coupled to the frame.

[0044] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 14”), further to any of Embodiments 1-13, installing the fastener through the coupling bracket includes installing the fastener through an aperture of the coupling bracket, and further including using the aperture as a centering guide before installing the fastener through the aperture of the coupling bracket.

[0045] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 15”), further to any of Embodiments 1-14, the coupling bracket includes an outer surface having a double taper, and further including positioning a shim between the double taper of the outer surface and the rough opening framing.

[0046] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 16”), further to any of Embodiments 1-15, positioning the shim between the double taper of the outer surface and the rough opening framing includes inserting the shim from above the coupling bracket.

[0047] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 17”), further to any of Embodiments 1-16, inserting the shim from above the coupling bracket includes permitting gravity to move the shim between the double taper of the outer surface and the rough opening framing.

[0048] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 18”), further to any of Embodiments 1-17, securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing includes permanently coupling the coupling bracket to the frame via the fastener.

[0049] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 19”), further to any of Embodiments 1-18, further including, after permanently coupling the coupling bracket to the frame via the fastener, detaching the first mounting bracket from the frame.

[0050] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 20”), further to any of Embodiments 1-19, further including, after seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening, abutting the first mounting bracket against the interior face of the rough opening framing, and securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing, detaching the first mounting bracket from the frame.

[0051] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 21”), further to any of Embodiments 1-20, the first mounting bracket further includes an actuator, and positioning the foot of the first mounting bracket in the channel of the frame includes actuating the actuator to move the foot relative to the frame.

[0052] According to another embodiment (“Embodiment 22”), further to any of Embodiments 1-21, the actuator includes a lever, and actuating the actuator includes pivoting the lever relative to the first leg of the first mounting bracket.

[0053] The foregoing embodiments and additional embodiments described herein should not be read to limit or otherwise narrow the scope of any of the inventive concepts otherwise provided by the instant disclosure. While multiple examples are disclosed, still other embodiments will become apparent to those skilled in the art from this specification and its drawings, which show and describe various illustrative examples. Accordingly, the drawings and detailed description are to be regarded as illustrative in nature rather than restrictive in nature.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0054] The accompanying drawings are included to provide a further understanding of the disclosure and are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate embodiments, and together with the description serve to explain the principles of the disclosure.

[0055] FIG. 1 is a top-oriented perspective view of a fenestration unit and rough opening framing from an interior side, according to some embodiments.

[0056] FIG. 2 is a bottom-oriented perspective view of the fenestration unit of FIG. 1 from an exterior side, according to some embodiments.

[0057] FIG. 3 is a detail perspective view of the features of the fenestration unit within line 3-3 of FIG. 1, including a mounting bracket, according to some embodiments.

[0058] FIG. 4 is a top section view of the fenestration unit taken along line 4-4 of FIG. 3, according to some embodiments.

[0059] FIG. 5 is a top-oriented perspective view of the mounting bracket of FIG. 3, according to some embodiments.

[0060] FIG. 6 is a bottom-oriented perspective view of the mounting bracket of FIG. 3, according to some embodiments.

[0061] FIG. 7 is a detail perspective view of the features of the fenestration unit within line 7-7 of FIG. 1, including a retainer, according to some embodiments.

[0062] FIG. 8 is a side section view of the fenestration unit taken along line 8-8 of FIG. 7,

according to some embodiments.

[0063] FIG. **9** is a top-oriented perspective view of the retainer of FIG. **7**, according to some embodiments.

[0064] FIG. **10** is a bottom-oriented perspective view of the retainer of FIG. **7**, according to some embodiments.

[0065] FIG. **11** is a detail perspective view of the features of the fenestration unit within line **11-11** of FIG. **2**, including a sill spacer, according to some embodiments.

[0066] FIG. **12** is a side section view of the fenestration unit taken along line **12-12** of FIG. **1**, according to some embodiments.

[0067] FIG. **13** is a top-oriented perspective view of another fenestration unit from an interior side, according to some embodiments.

[0068] FIG. **14** is a bottom-oriented perspective view of the fenestration unit of FIG. **13** from an exterior side, according to some embodiments.

[0069] FIG. **15** is a detail perspective view of the features of the fenestration unit within line **15-15** of FIG. **13**, including a mounting bracket, according to some embodiments.

[0070] FIG. **16** is a top section view of the fenestration unit taken along line **16-16** of FIG. **15**, according to some embodiments.

[0071] FIG. **17** is a top-oriented perspective view of the mounting bracket of FIG. **15**, according to some embodiments.

[0072] FIG. **18** is a bottom-oriented perspective view of the mounting bracket of FIG. **15**, according to some embodiments.

[0073] FIG. **19** is a detail perspective view of the features of the fenestration unit within line **19-19** of FIG. **13**, including a retainer, according to some embodiments.

[0074] FIG. **20** is a side section view of the fenestration unit taken along line **20-20** of FIG. **19**, according to some embodiments.

[0075] FIG. **21** is a top-oriented perspective view of the retainer of FIG. **19**, according to some embodiments.

[0076] FIG. **22** is a bottom-oriented perspective view of the retainer of FIG. **19**, according to some embodiments.

[0077] FIG. **23** is a partial top section view of a frame and a mounting bracket of another fenestration unit, according to some embodiments.

[0078] FIG. **24** is a perspective view of the mounting bracket of FIG. **23**, according to some embodiments.

[0079] FIG. **25** is a top view of a cam of the mounting bracket in a channel of the frame of FIG. **23** and an unlocked configuration, according to some embodiments.

[0080] FIG. **26** is a top view of the cam of the mounting bracket in the channel of the frame of FIG. **25** and a locked configuration, according to some embodiments.

[0081] FIG. **27** is a top-oriented perspective view of another fenestration unit from an interior side, according to some embodiments.

[0082] FIG. **28** is a side section view of yet another fenestration unit, rough opening framing, and an interior wall covering, according to some embodiments.

[0083] FIG. **29** is a side section view of a mounting bracket of a fenestration unit, according to some embodiments.

[0084] FIG. **30** is a bottom-oriented perspective view of another fenestration unit from an interior side, according to some embodiments.

[0085] FIG. **31** is a side section view of the fenestration unit taken along line **31-31** of FIG. **30**, according to some embodiments.

[0086] FIG. **32** is a bottom-oriented perspective view of another fenestration unit from an interior side, according to some embodiments.

[0087] FIG. **33** is a side section view of the fenestration unit taken along line **33-33** of FIG. **32**,

according to some embodiments.

[0088] FIG. **34** is a top perspective view of another fenestration unit from an interior side, according to some embodiments.

[0089] FIG. **35** is a bottom perspective view of the fenestration unit of FIG. **34** from the interior side, according to some embodiments.

[0090] FIG. **36** is a detail view of features of the fenestration unit within line **36-36** of FIG. **34**, including coupling brackets, a mounting bracket, and a retainer, according to some embodiments.

[0091] FIG. **37** is a side view of the mounting bracket and the retainer of FIG. **35**, according to some embodiments.

[0092] FIG. **38** is a perspective view of the mounting bracket of FIG. **35**, according to some embodiments.

[0093] FIG. **39** is a detail top view of the mounting bracket of FIG. **35** and a frame of the fenestration unit of FIG. **35** with a movable leg of the mounting bracket in a retracted configuration, according to some embodiments.

[0094] FIG. **40** is a detail top view of the mounting bracket and the frame of FIG. **35** with the movable leg of the mounting bracket in an extended configuration.

[0095] FIG. **41** is a perspective view of the coupling bracket of FIG. **35**, according to some embodiments.

[0096] FIG. **42** is a bottom view of the coupling bracket of FIG. **35**, according to some embodiments.

[0097] FIG. **43** is a side view of the coupling bracket of FIG. **35**, according to some embodiments.

[0098] FIG. **44** is a side view of the coupling bracket coupled to the frame of FIG. **35**, and with a shim positioned between the coupling bracket and rough opening framing, according to some embodiments.

[0099] FIG. **45** is a bottom-oriented, detail perspective view of features of the fenestration unit of FIG. **35**, including the coupling bracket, the mounting bracket, and the retainer, and rough opening framing, according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

Definitions and Terminology

[0100] This disclosure is not meant to be read in a restrictive manner. For example, the terminology used in the application should be read broadly in the context of the meaning those in the field would attribute such terminology.

[0101] With respect to terminology of inexactitude, the terms “about” and “approximately” may be used, interchangeably, to refer to a measurement that includes the stated measurement and that also includes any measurements that are reasonably close to the stated measurement. Measurements that are reasonably close to the stated measurement deviate from the stated measurement by a reasonably small amount as understood and readily ascertained by individuals having ordinary skill in the relevant arts. Such deviations may be attributable to measurement error, differences in measurement and/or manufacturing equipment calibration, human error in reading and/or setting measurements, minor adjustments made to optimize performance and/or structural parameters in view of differences in measurements associated with other components, particular implementation scenarios, imprecise adjustment and/or manipulation of objects by a person or machine, and/or the like, for example. In the event it is determined that individuals having ordinary skill in the relevant arts would not readily ascertain values for such reasonably small differences, the terms “about” and “approximately” can be understood to mean plus or minus 10% of the stated value.

[0102] Persons skilled in the art will readily appreciate that various aspects of the present disclosure can be realized by any number of methods and apparatuses configured to perform the intended functions. It should also be noted that the accompanying drawing figures referred to herein are not necessarily drawn to scale and may be exaggerated to illustrate various aspects of the present disclosure, and in that regard, the drawing figures should not be construed as limiting.

Description of Various Embodiments

[0103] Various concepts of this patent specification address installation systems and methods for fenestration units, such as windows and doors. Some features of such systems and methods include one or more of the following: configured to be set into a rough opening from an interior side of a building or wall; eliminated or reduced need for jamb and/or sill spacers; pre-applied sill spacers (e.g., factory-applied); pre-applied head stabilizers and/or jamb stabilizers for self-stabilization in the rough opening while leveling, plumbing, squaring, and/or anchoring the fenestration unit; gauged to the interior face of the rough opening for more accurate finishing (e.g., drywall and/or trim) offsets; attached with pre-applied (e.g., factory-applied) mounting brackets configured for interior unit installation; shipped or supplied with mounting brackets configured for interior unit installation; no or reduced fasteners utilized on the exterior side of the fenestration unit; pre-attached (e.g., factory-applied) exterior water barrier (e.g., pop-up fin); storable and deployable exterior water barrier (e.g., constrained by removable packaging clips for shipping/installation); facilitates standard flashing tape methods; configured to be installed by a single person/installer; interior and exterior installation tasks can be performed at different times (e.g., with a substantial break in period of time between the two types of tasks).

[0104] In various examples, the fenestration units (e.g., fenestration unit **100**) include features that promote installation of the fenestration unit from an interior side of a rough opening using a methodology that can be readily achieved by a single installer. In particular, a fenestration unit according to various examples includes a retention system coupled to the frame of the fenestration unit that is operable to exert a retention force on the fenestration unit to maintain positive engagement of the fenestration unit with the rough opening framing and resist extraction of the fenestration unit from the rough opening upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening from the interior side of the rough opening. The retention system may operate such that the fenestration unit remains stationary in the rough opening without use of fasteners securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing. The fenestration unit may include an engagement system coupled to the frame, the engagement system configured to positively engage the interior face of the rough opening framing upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening from the interior side of the rough opening. In turn, the aforementioned retention system may operate to maintain positive engagement of the retention system with the rough opening framing upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening from the interior side of the rough opening and without use of fasteners securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing.

[0105] In this manner, a single individual may insert a fenestration unit into a rough opening from the interior side thereof, without needing a second person to hold the fenestration unit against the rough opening framing, or otherwise assist with maintaining the positioning of the fenestration unit in the rough opening. This retention feature also removes the need for the installer to use one hand to hold the fenestration unit against the rough opening framing, freeing both hands of the installer to carry out the installation process, such as securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening using fasteners, such as nails or screws, and/or leveling, plumbing, and squaring the fenestration unit within the rough opening.

[0106] FIGS. **1** and **2** illustrate a fenestration unit **100**, according to some embodiments, where FIG. **1** is a top-oriented perspective view from an interior side **10** of a building or wall and FIG. **2** is a bottom-oriented perspective view from an exterior side **12** of the building or wall. FIGS. **1** and **2** illustrate the fenestration unit **100** in an installing configuration in which the unit **100** is configured for positioning in a rough opening **14** defined by rough opening framing **16** (illustrated in phantom lines in FIG. **1**) of the building or wall. As described in further detail below, the fenestration unit **100** is also configurable in an initial, or pre-installation configuration (e.g., as initially received by an installer) and a final, installed configuration, or installation configuration (e.g., secured in the rough opening).

[0107] As shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**, the fenestration unit **100** generally includes a top **102**, a bottom

104, a first side **106**, and a second side **108**. The fenestration unit **100** includes a frame **110** including a head **112**, a first jamb **114**, a second jamb **116**, and a sill **118**. These components of the frame **110** together define an outer perimeter **120**, a front or interior face **122** (FIG. 1), as well as a back or exterior face **124** (FIG. 2). As illustrated, the frame **110** may be a vinyl frame design. However, fiberglass, wood, or other materials may be implemented for the frame **110**.

[0108] The fenestration unit **100** also includes a panel unit or glazing unit **126** supported by the frame **110**. The glazing unit **40** may be any of a variety of configurations, but in some embodiments is an insulated glass (IG) unit. As shown, the fenestration unit **100** is configured as a fixed window, but any of a variety of configurations (casement, single hung, double hung, awning or other) are also contemplated.

[0109] As shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, the fenestration unit **100** includes one or more installation features that facilitate installation of the fenestration unit **100** in the rough opening **14**. For example, as shown, the fenestration unit **100** may include one or more of the following installation features: a mounting bracket system **128** (also described as an engagement system), a retention system including an installation stabilizer system **130** (FIG. 1) and a sill spacer system **132** (FIG. 2), a weather seal system **134**. These features are described in further detail below.

[0110] With continued reference to FIGS. 1 and 2 and additional reference to FIGS. 3-6, the mounting bracket system **128** generally includes a plurality of mounting brackets **136** coupled to the outer perimeter **120** of the frame **110**. The mounting bracket system **128** may include various numbers of mounting brackets **136**, such as four (4), six (6), eight (8), ten (10), or more mounting brackets **136**. In some embodiments, half of the mounting brackets **136** are coupled to the first jamb **114** and half of the mounting brackets **136** are coupled to the second jamb **116**, although a variety of configurations are contemplated, including mounting brackets **136** on the head **112** and/or sill **118**. Generally, embodiments include at least four (4) mounting brackets **136**, two upper mounting brackets **136** toward the head **112** and two lower mounting brackets **136** toward the sill **118**. As the dimensions of the fenestration unit **100** increase, more mounting brackets **136** may be warranted to facilitate anchoring of the fenestration unit **100**.

[0111] As described in further detail below, the mounting brackets **136** may be sized to provide an intended depth, or gauged, for installation (e.g., to accommodate jamb extensions and/or interior wall covering (e.g., drywall) returns). That is, the mounting brackets **136** may facilitate gauging the fenestration unit **100** from an interior face **18** of the rough opening **14** (FIG. 1). This gauging capability helps ensure a proper offset for interior wall covering thickness or other wall features and may help eliminate or reduce such problems as jamb extensions of the fenestration unit **100** being “proud” or “recessed” from an interior face of the finished wall surface (e.g., inner drywall face). The resulting installation using the mounting brackets **136** may facilitate flush jamb extensions relative to the interior face of the wall (e.g., inner drywall face) which makes the installation of trim (e.g., casing) of the fenestration unit **100** much more efficient for subsequent detailing steps (e.g., finish carpenters).

[0112] In some implementations, the mounting brackets **136** are initially provided to an installer (e.g., shipped or delivered to the installer) in an initial or pre-installation configuration in which the mounting brackets **136** are detached from the frame **110**. As part of the installation process, an installer (not shown) positions each mounting bracket **136** at appropriate location along the perimeter **120** of the frame **110** (e.g., a pre-selected location or an installer-selected location, as described in further detail below) and couples the mounting bracket **136** to the frame **110** (e.g., by camming, or rotating, the mounting bracket **136** into a receiving feature in the frame **110** and, optionally, striking the mounting bracket **136** with a mallet or other tool, or pressing on the mounting bracket **136** by hand). Specific features of the mounting brackets **136** that facilitate coupling to the frame **110** are described in further detail below.

[0113] As shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, the mounting brackets **136** may each be substantially similar to one another and may be described cumulatively in association with a first one of the mounting

brackets **136**, an example of which (a first mounting bracket **136a**) is depicted in FIGS. 3-5.

[0114] As shown in FIGS. 3-5, the first mounting bracket **136a** generally includes a first leg **138** and a second leg **140**. The first leg **138** and the second leg **140** may be integrally formed, or monolithically coupled, by fabricating the first mounting bracket **136a** via sheet metal stamping and bending processes. In other embodiments, the first mounting bracket **136a** may be fabricated using other materials and/or processes (e.g., cast or molded), and the first leg **138** and the second leg **140** may be coupled in other manners, such as via one or more fasteners, welds, or otherwise (not shown).

[0115] Referring specifically to FIGS. 4-6, the first leg **138** of the first mounting bracket **136a** includes one or more first feet **142** (illustratively one first foot **142**) and one or more second feet **144** (illustratively one second foot **144**) that are generally disposed apart from the second leg **140**. As shown, an end portion **141** of the first leg **138** extends between the first foot **142** and the second foot **144**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, each first foot **142** includes an ankle portion **143** and an angled toe portion **145** coupled to the ankle portion **143**. Similarly, in some embodiments and as illustrated, each second foot **144** includes an ankle portion **149** and an angled toe portion **151** coupled to the ankle portion **149**. In certain embodiments and as illustrated, each second foot **144** further includes one or more claws **153** extending from the angled toe portion **151**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the claws **153** collectively form a serrated edge-like structure. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the toe portion **151** and the claws **153** project at an acute angle from the ankle portion **149**.

[0116] The first foot **142** and the second foot **144** are received in a channel **146** formed on the perimeter **120** of the frame **110** to secure the first mounting bracket **136a** to the frame **110**. More specifically and referring to FIG. 4, the first foot **142**, specifically the angled toe portion **145**, is received in a first slot **148** formed in first sidewall **150** of the channel **146**, and the second foot **144**, specifically the angled toe portion **151** and the claws **153**, is received in a second slot **152** formed in the second sidewall **154** of the channel **146**. Illustratively, the first sidewall **150** and the second sidewall **154** may face toward each other, and accordingly the first slot **148** and the second slot **152** may face toward each other, and the first foot **142** and the second foot **144** accordingly may face away from each other to facilitate receipt in the first slot **148** and the second slot **152**, respectively. In other embodiments, the first foot **142** and the second foot **144** may have different arrangements depending on the arrangement of the first slot **148** and the second slot **152**. The first foot **142** and the second foot **144** and/or the first sidewall **150** and the second sidewall **154** may be sufficiently flexible to facilitate bending and receiving the feet **142**, **144** in the slots **148**, **152**, respectively, when coupling the mounting bracket **136a** to the frame **110**. In some embodiments, the mounting bracket **136a** is coupled to the frame **110** by camming, or rotating, the bracket **136a** relative to the frame **110**. More specifically, the first foot **142** is inserted into the first slot **148** of the channel **146**, then the second foot **144** is inserted into the second slot **152** of the channel **146**. In some embodiments, the second foot **144** is driven past the second sidewall **154** and into the second slot **152** by applying additional force to the mounting bracket **136a** (e.g., by pressing on the mounting bracket **136a** by hand, striking the mounting bracket **136a** with a mallet, or the like). The first slot **148** and the second slot **152** may be formed in the first sidewall **150** and the second sidewall **154**, respectively, at pre-selected locations or continuously about the perimeter **120** of the frame **110**. The first slot **148** and the second slot **152** may be formed on the frame **110** in cutting process (e.g., using a key seat cutter) or otherwise. In other embodiments, the mounting brackets **136** may be coupled to the frame **110** in additional or other manners, such as via fasteners, more specifically screws or rivets, or adhesives, such as very high bond (VHB) tape.

[0117] As described briefly above and referring specifically to FIG. 4, the mounting brackets **136** may be sized to provide an intended depth for installation. More specifically, the length of the mounting brackets **136** between the rear edge of a fin assembly **176** of the weather seal system **134** (in its unconstrained or deployed configuration, shown in phantom lines, as described in further

(detail below) and the second legs **140** may be sized to provide the intended depth **D1** for installation. The length of the mounting brackets **136** may provide an intended installation depth **D1**, e.g., in a range of 3.750 to 4.125 in. for a 2×4 wall and a range of 5.750 in. to 6.125 in. for a 2×6 wall.

[0118] With reference again to FIGS. **3-6**, the second leg **140** of the first mounting bracket **136a** extends approximately perpendicularly from the first leg **138** and outward relative to the frame **110**. The second leg **140** is configured to abut the interior face **18** of the rough opening framing **16** (FIG. **1**) and thereby properly position the fenestration unit **100** in the rough opening **14**. The second leg **140** includes one or more apertures **156** (illustratively, two apertures **156**), and each aperture **156** is configured to receive a fastener (not shown) for securing the fenestration unit **100** to the rough opening framing **16**. The apertures **156** may be recessed or countersunk to permit screw heads to be mounted flush. In this way, the fasteners will not interfere with an interior wall covering (e.g., drywall) or other wall treatment installed over the second leg **140**.

[0119] With reference to FIGS. **7-10**, the installation stabilizer system **130** includes one or more retainers **158**, also described as stabilizer clips **158**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the installation stabilizer system **130** includes one retainer **158**. In some embodiments, the retainer **158** may be detached from the frame **110** in the pre-installation configuration. In other embodiments, the retainer **158** may be coupled to the frame **110** in the pre-installation configuration. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the retainer **158** is positioned on the head **112** of the frame **110**. The retainer **158** may be fabricated by sheet metal stamping and bending processes.

[0120] Generally, the retainer **158** is configured to permit insertion of the frame **110** within the rough opening **14** (shown elsewhere) in a first insertion direction **D1** (FIG. **8**) and resist extraction of the frame **110** from the rough opening **14** in a second extraction direction **D2** (FIG. **8**). The retainer **158** includes a base **160** configured to be secured to the frame **110** (FIGS. **7** and **8**), and one or more flex arms **162** extending from the base **160**. Each flex arm **162** includes one or more engagement features **164** (FIGS. **9** and **10**) at a terminal end. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the engagement features **164** are generally rectangular teeth-like structures that are configured to “bite” into the rough opening framing. In some embodiments and as illustrated, one or more of the flex arms **162** may have a different length and/or extend from the base **160** at a different position than other flex arms **162**. For example and as illustrated in FIGS. **9** and **10**, the retainer **158** includes a first flex arm **162a** extending from a first side of the base **160**, a second flex arm **162b** extending from a second side of the base **160**, and a third flex arm **162c** generally disposed between the first flex arm **162a** and the second flex arm **162b**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the first flex arm **162a** has a first length, the second flex arm **162b** has a second length less than the first length, and the third flex arm **162c** has a third length less than the second length. In some embodiments, the different lengths of the flex arms **162** advantageously permit the fenestration unit **100** to be installed in rough openings of various sizes, in particular rough openings that provide different gap sizes between the head **112** of the frame **100** and the rough opening framing. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the third flex arm **162c** extends from the base **160** at a position that is horizontally offset (e.g., as shown in FIG. **8**) from a position on the base **160** from which the first flex arm **162a** and the second flex arm **162b** extend. In certain embodiments, this arrangement of the flex arms **162a**, **162b**, and **162c** advantageously inhibits the relatively long arms (that is, the first flex arm **162a** and the second flex arm **162b**) from extending past the interior face **122** of the frame **100** (shown elsewhere) when positioned in the rough opening. In some embodiments, all of the flex arms **162** may have the same length and/or extend from the base **160** at the same position. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the flex arms **162a**, **162b**, and **162c** extend from the base **160** at the same angle. In some embodiments, the flex arms **162a**, **162b**, and **162c** extend from the base **160** different angles, or are otherwise structured to provide the flex arms **162a**, **162b**, and **162c** with different heights relative to the base **160**. Stated another way, in some embodiments the first flex arm **162a** has a first height relative to the base

160, the second flex arm **162b** has a second height relative to the base **160** less than the first height, and the third flex arm **162c** has a third height relative to the base **160** less than the second height. [0121] In some embodiments, the base **160** includes one or more first feet **166** (illustratively one first foot **166**) and one or more second feet **168** (illustratively two second feet **168**) for securing the retainer **158** to the frame **110**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, each first foot **166** includes an ankle portion **167** and an angled toe portion **169** coupled to the ankle portion **167**. Similarly, in some embodiments and as illustrated, each second foot **168** includes an ankle portion **171** and an angled toe portion **173** coupled to the ankle portion **171**. In certain embodiments and as illustrated, each second foot **168** further includes one or more claws **175** extending from the angled toe portion **173**. The claws **175** may collectively form a serrated edge-like structure. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the toe portion **173** and the claws **175** project at an acute angle from the ankle portion **171**.

[0122] The first foot **166** and the second feet **168** are received in the channel **146** (FIGS. 7 and 8) formed on the perimeter **120** of the frame **110** to secure the retainer **158** to the frame **110**. More specifically and referring to FIG. 8, the first foot **166**, specifically the angled toe portion **169**, is received in the first slot **148** formed in first sidewall **150** of the channel **146**, and the second feet **168**, more specifically the angled toe portions **173** and the claws **175**, are received in the second slot **152** formed in the second sidewall **154** of the channel **146**. Illustratively, the first sidewall **150** and the second sidewall **154** may face toward each other, and the first foot **166** and the second feet **168** accordingly may face away from each other to facilitate receipt in the first slot **148** and the second slot **152**, respectively. In other embodiments, the first foot **166** and the second feet **168** may have different arrangements depending on the arrangement of the first slot **148** and the second slot **152**. The first foot **166** and the second feet **168** and/or the first sidewall **150** and the second sidewall **154** may be sufficiently flexible to facilitate bending and receiving the feet **166**, **168** in the slots **148**, **152** when coupling the retainer **158** to the frame **110**. In some embodiments, the retainer **158** is coupled to the frame **110** by camming, or rotating, the retainer **158** relative to the frame **110**. More specifically, the first foot **166** is inserted into the first slot **148** of the channel **146**, then the second feet **168** are inserted into the second slot **152** of the channel **146**. In some embodiments, the second feet **168** are driven past the second sidewall **154** and into the second slot **152** by applying additional force to the retainer **158** (e.g., by pressing on the retainer **158** by hand, striking the retainer **158** with a mallet, or the like). In some embodiments, the retainer **158** may be coupled to the frame **110** in other manners, such as via adhesion or fasteners.

[0123] During insertion of the frame **110** in the first insertion direction **D1** (FIG. 8), one or more of the flex arms **162** of the retainer **158** (e.g., the longest flex arm **162** if a large gap is present between the frame **110** and the rough opening framing **16** or all of the flex arms **162** if a small gap is present) bends or is deflected in a first flex direction. The insertion force, or force required to move the unit **100** in the first direction **D1** may be, for example, 1 lb. or less, more than 1 lb, more than 10 lbs, or more than 15 lbs. Upon application of a force on the frame **110** in the second extraction direction **D2**, the flex arm **162** bends in a second flex direction to resist movement of the frame **110** in the second direction **D2** (e.g., toward the interior side). The extraction or tipping force, or force required to move the unit **100** in the second direction **D2** after seating may be greater than the insertion force. The extraction force may be, for example, 1 lb. or less, more than 1 lb, 10 lbs or more, at least 15 lbs, or 15 lbs or more. In some examples, the extraction force is 80 lbs or more, or approximately 88 lbs. Generally, a higher extraction or tipping force (e.g., as compared to the insertion force) helps ensure the fenestration unit **100** remains in place after being inserted into the rough opening **14** to permit subsequent levelling and/or securement procedures.

[0124] Further aspects of the installation stabilizer system **130** and the retainer(s) **158** may be as described in U.S. application Ser. No. 18/478,189, filed Sep. 29, 2023, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes.

[0125] Referring to FIG. 11 and with additional reference to FIG. 2, the sill spacer system **132**

includes one or more sill spacers **170**, such as a pair of sill spacers **170** (one spacer **170** being illustrated in FIG. **11**, both spacers being illustrated in FIG. **2**), attached to the bottom of the frame **110** at the sill **118**. In some embodiments, the sill spacers **170** may be detached from the frame **110** in the pre-installation configuration. In other embodiments, the sill spacers **170** may be coupled to the frame **110** in the pre-installation configuration.

[0126] In some embodiments, the sill spacer system **132** provides a convenient mechanism for positioning and leveling the fenestration unit **100** inside the rough opening **14** (shown elsewhere). In some embodiments, the sill spacer system **132** facilitates centering the fenestration unit **100** within the rough opening **14** by reducing friction between the frame **110** of the fenestration unit **100** and the rough opening **14** as they move against each other. The sill spacer system **132** establishes a gap between the rough opening **14** and the sill **118** to make it easier for an installer to adjust the position of the fenestration unit **100** (e.g., insert a pry bar or other tool under the sill **118** of the fenestration unit **100** for lifting and leveling). Shims, such as standard wood shims, can be slid under the sill spacer system **132** for leveling the fenestration unit **100** within the rough opening **14**.

[0127] With continued reference to FIG. **11**, each sill spacer **170** may be positioned in the channel **146** formed on the perimeter **120** on the frame **110**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, each sill spacer **170** may be coupled to the frame **110** via an adhesive **172**. In other embodiments, the sill spacer(s) **170** may be coupled to the frame **110** in other manners, such as via fasteners or a plurality of feet, such as feet similar to those of the mounting bracket **136a** or the retainer **158** (shown elsewhere). In some embodiments and as illustrated, each sill spacer **170** includes a flat lower contact surface **174**. Stated another way, each sill spacer **170** is substantially rectangular and lacks any angles or ramps. In some embodiments, each sill spacer **170** includes standard rounds or chamfers on corners typical of molding and/or extrusion processes. In some embodiments, the substantially rectangular shape of the sill spacer **170** advantageously provides no directionality for installation of the unit **100**, maximizes the contact surface of the sill spacer **170**, and/or facilitates level seating of the unit **100** in a rough opening. In other embodiments, each sill spacer **170** includes a rounded lower contact surface, and/or any of the features of the sill spacers described in U.S. Application No. 18/478,189, filed Sep. 29, 2023, previously incorporated by reference.

[0128] Referring to FIG. **12**, and with additional reference to FIGS. **1** and **2**, the weather seal system **134** acts as an exterior water barrier. The weather seal system **134** may be biased to a deployed configuration or may be otherwise described as a “pop-up” fin system. In various examples, the weather seal system **134** is initially provided (e.g., in the pre-installation configuration and the installing configuration shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**) in a stowed or flattened position against the frame **110** of the fenestration unit **100**. This stowed or flattened position can be described as a “180° position”. The weather seal system **134** may be held in the stowed position by a detachable retaining assembly **171**. After the fenestration unit **100** is installed and anchored (e.g., using one or more fasteners, such as screws or nails) the original installer(s) (not shown) or another installer or installer(s) may separately proceed to the exterior side of the rough opening **14** to remove the retaining assembly and transition the weather seal system **134** to the deployed configuration (and the unit **100** thereby reaching its final, installation configuration). In some examples, upon removal of the retaining assembly, the weather seal system **134** automatically pops-up, or projects outwardly from the frame **110** (as shown in phantom lines in FIG. **12**; e.g., at approximately 90°, or biased to rotate beyond 90° to encourage positive engagement) to rest against the exterior surface of the wall in which the rough opening **14** is formed.

[0129] In various examples, no fasteners (e.g., screws or nails) are used on the exterior side of the fenestration unit **100** (e.g., the fenestration unit **100** is secured entirely from the interior side of the rough opening **14**). Flashing tape or other treatments may be applied around the perimeter of the fenestration unit **100**, over the weather seal system **134** to seal the fenestration unit **100** to the exterior surface of the wall in which the rough opening **14** is formed. In various examples, the

exterior surface of the wall may include a weather resistant barrier (e.g., Tyvek® home wrap available from DuPont de Nemours, Inc.).

[0130] With continued reference to FIG. 12 and additional reference to FIGS. 1 and 2, the weather seal system 134 includes the fin assembly 176, which is outwardly biased to project radially outward from the perimeter 120 of the frame 110 when unconstrained. The fin assembly 176 generally includes a plurality of fins, including a head fin 178, a first jamb fin 180, a second jamb fin (not shown), and a sill fin 182. FIG. 12 is a section view of the head fin 178 and the other fins each may have a substantially similar construction, with differences in length corresponding to the portion of the frame 110 to which they are attached. As shown, each of the fins includes a coupling portion 184, a projection portion 186, and a hinge portion 188 between the coupling portion 184 and the projection portion 186. The coupling portion 184 is disposed in a channel 190 formed in the perimeter 120 (FIGS. 1 and 2) of the frame 110 and the projection portion 186 is biased by the hinge portion 188 to project radially outward from the perimeter 120 in the deployed configuration. In some embodiments, the coupling portion 184 may be coupled to the frame 110 via an adhesive 192. However, other attachment methods are contemplated, including any of those previously described.

[0131] Other aspects of the weather seal system 134 and the fin assembly 176 may be as described in U.S. application Ser. No. 18/478,189, filed Sep. 29, 2023, previously incorporated by reference. For example, the weather seal system 134 may further include corner bridge seals between the fins and/or a retaining assembly for initially holding the fin assembly 176 in the stowed position as described in the incorporated application. As another example, the fin assembly 176 may include features, such as the dimples described in the incorporated application, or waffling features debossed into the fin assembly 176 that facilitate venting such that the water-managed cavity between the frame 110 and the rough opening is at exterior air pressure.

[0132] Installation of the fenestration unit 100 may proceed in view of the various concepts described in the foregoing sections. In particular, installation of the fenestration unit 100 in the rough opening 14 may proceed from the interior side of the rough opening 14 and may be executed by a single installer initially on the interior side of the rough opening 14.

[0133] As part of the installation process, the rough opening 14 should be prepared for installation of the fenestration unit 100. Generally, the rough opening 14 is sized to be between ½ inches and ¾ inches larger than the fenestration unit 100 in both width and height, although other setups may also be suitable. Some methods also include forming the rough opening 14, such as by cutting out the rough opening (e.g., plywood cladding covering rough opening framing). The sill portion of the rough opening framing 16 (i.e., the lower framing) may be flashed (e.g., using appropriate flashing tape).

[0134] The fenestration unit 100 is then partially deployed from the pre-installation configuration to the installing configuration. In some examples, the brackets 136 and the retainer 158 are initially supplied with the unit 100 in shipping packaging (not shown). In some examples, the brackets 136 are supplied as a kit of parts, with a variety of different configurations to facilitate different installation scenarios (e.g., having different lengths for facilitating different registration depths in the rough opening 14). In some embodiments, the, the mounting brackets 136 and the retainer 158 are coupled to the frame 110 of the unit 100 to partially deploy from the pre-installation configuration to the installing configuration. In some embodiments, the brackets 136 are coupled to the frame 110 by positioning the first feet 142 and second feet 144 in the channel 146 as described above, and the retainer 158 is coupled to the frame 110 by positioning the first foot 142 and the second foot 144 in the channel 146 as described above.

[0135] The fenestration unit 100 is inserted or pushed unit into the rough opening 14 from the interior side of the rough opening 14, for example by a single installer. The ability and functionality to be installed from an interior side of the rough opening 14 may be an advantageous feature of the fenestration unit 100, as traditional fenestration installations require at least one installer on the

exterior side of a rough opening and/or at least one installer on the interior side of the rough opening.

[0136] In some embodiments, the fenestration unit **100** is inserted into the rough opening **14** by first inserting a bottom of the fenestration unit **100** into the rough opening **14** and then tilting the top of the fenestration unit **100** toward an exterior side of the rough opening **14** such that the installation stabilizer system **130** exerts a retention force on the fenestration unit **100** by maintaining positive engagement of the fenestration unit **100** with the rough opening framing **16**. The installation stabilizer system **130** permits insertion of the fenestration unit **100** within the rough opening **14** in a first, interior-to-exterior direction at a first insertion force and resist extraction of the fenestration unit from the opening in a second, exterior-to-interior direction at a second extraction force, the second extraction force being substantially greater than the first insertion force. The method includes inserting the fenestration unit **100** within the rough opening **14** in the first direction at a force that meets or exceeds the insertion force.

[0137] The fenestration unit **100** is pushed into the rough opening **14** until the mounting brackets **136** engage the rough opening framing **16**, specifically the jamb portions of the rough opening framing **16**. The mounting brackets **136** act as an engagement system that is positively engaged with the interior face of the rough opening framing **16** from the interior side of the rough opening **14** and the installation stabilizer system **130** maintains positive engagement of the engagement system with the rough opening framing **16** upon insertion therein.

[0138] The fenestration unit **100** is then centered in the rough opening **14**. In some embodiments, the fenestration unit **100** begins spaced from the sill portion of the rough opening framing **16** a desired distance due to the thickness of the sill spacers **170**. In some embodiments, this distance is approximately $\frac{1}{4}$ inches. The fenestration unit **100** may be centered side-to-side by inserting a screwdriver having a standard head (e.g., $\frac{1}{4}$ -inch-thick head) and rotating the screw driver to ensure a minimum desired gap is achieved at the first and second jambs **114**, **116** of the frame **110**. To begin the shimming/levelling processes, a level is used to check the horizontal level of the fenestration unit **100** and a single shim is slid underneath the low side sill spacer **170**. Additional shims are applied as needed to achieve a desired level and sill spacing with periodic measuring of horizontal level as needed.

[0139] Once a desired levelling and spacing is achieved, fasteners (e.g., screws or nails) are driven through the lowermost mounting brackets **136** and into the rough opening framing **16**. The fenestration unit **100** can then continue to be plumbed, squared, and fully coupled to the rough opening framing **16**. For example, a user may plumb one of the first jamb **114** and the second jamb **116** to vertical level. This operation of adjusting vertical level at the first jamb **114** and/or the second jamb **116** may be carried out using a tool (e.g., a crowbar or prybar) to adjust the plumb of the jambs **114**, **116**. Additionally, or alternatively, an installer may use an air bag designed for such a purpose that can be inflated to adjust the gap between the jambs **114**, **116** and the rough opening framing, and thus vertical level thereof, or other suitable methods may be implemented as desired. Once plumbed to be vertically level, the remaining mounting brackets **136** are secured to the rough opening framing **16** using fasteners, such that the fenestration unit **100** is structurally secured to the rough opening framing **16**.

[0140] The installer may apply an air sealant (e.g., spray foam or other air seal material) around the outer perimeter **120** of the fenestration unit **100** in the gap between the rough opening framing **16** and the fenestration unit **100** to create an interior air seal. This interior air seal may be continuous and substantially, or entirely, uninterrupted. An interior air seal typically is necessary for proper water management. As previously referenced, the positioning of the sill spacer system **132** helps provide sufficient gap for the air sealant to be deposited in the gap, and also provides a continuous gap around the perimeter of the fenestration unit **100** to ensure a continuous seal can be formed. This sealing operation is typically carried out from an interior side of the rough opening. Notably, the sealant may be applied before, or after the exterior water barrier steps described below in

association with the weather seal system **134**.

[0141] In contrast to other methods and systems, at this point the fenestration unit **100** is entirely squared, plumbed, and securely fastened in the rough opening **14** all from the interior side of the rough opening **14**. This can be accomplished by a single installer, rather than requiring two installers. However, in the case of particularly large fenestration units, multiple installers may still be required to lift and position the fenestration unit. Regardless, at that time, or a later time as desired, the same installer, or another installer, may proceed to the exterior side of the rough opening **14** to finish exterior water barrier installation for the fenestration unit **100** in the rough opening. This is in contrast with traditional, nailing fin installations which require a second installer to be present on the exterior side of the rough opening during installation of the fenestration unit.

[0142] Forming an exterior water barrier for the installation unit **100** may include removing the retaining clips (not shown) such that the plurality of fins transition from the stowed configuration to a radial outwardly projecting installation, or deployed configuration. In various operations, the retaining clips may be removed in any order. In other operations, the retaining clip near the sill is removed first, followed by the retaining clips near the jambs, and finally the retaining clip near the head. This order can help ensure the proper overlapping of the fins and the corner bridge seals (not shown), with the sill fin **182** being outwardly overlapping with the jamb fins **180**.

[0143] Generally, no fasteners are used with the fins, which is in contrast to traditional nailing fins. Though such fasteners (e.g., screws or nails) are not present in various examples, it is contemplated that such fasteners could be implemented in other embodiments. Regardless, installation proceeds by using flashing tape or another suitable flashing material to flash over the first and second jamb fins **180** and then the head fin **178**. Generally, weather resistant barrier (e.g., Tyvek® home wrap available from DuPont de Nemours, Inc.) will be present on the exterior wall of a building and will be cut with two 45 degree cuts at the rough opening head corners and folded vertically against itself. Once the jamb fins **180** and the head fin **178** have been flashed, the weather resistant barrier can be folded back down over the head fin **178** and flashing (e.g., flashing tape) can be applied across the 45 degree cuts at the corners. Flashing (e.g., flashing tape) is not applied to the sill fin **182** in various examples. This absence of sealing at the sill **118** of the frame **110** can help ensure that the sill fin **182** acts as a water barrier, but not an air seal at the sill **118**. This water-but-non-air barrier configuration promotes equalization of air pressure at a location under the sill **118** and exterior to the rough opening sealant to exterior air pressure. This equalization to exterior air pressure can help prevent water from being forced or drawn up through the water seal at the sill **118** during a storm or other high external ambient air pressure event.

[0144] FIGS. **13** and **14** illustrate a fenestration unit **200**, according to some embodiments, where FIG. **13** is a top-oriented perspective view from the interior side **10** of a building or wall and FIG. **14** is a bottom-oriented perspective view from an exterior side **12** of the building or wall. FIGS. **13** and **14** illustrate the fenestration unit **200** in an installing configuration in which the unit **200** is configured for positioning in a rough opening defined by rough opening framing (shown elsewhere) of the building or wall. The fenestration unit **200** is also configurable in an initial or pre-installation configuration (e.g., as initially received by an installer) and a final, installed configuration, or installation configuration (e.g., secured in the rough opening).

[0145] The fenestration unit **200** generally includes a frame **202** having an outer perimeter **204**, a front or interior face **206** (FIG. **13**), as well as a back or exterior face **208** (FIG. **14**). As illustrated, the frame **202** may be a fiberglass frame design. However, vinyl, wood, or other materials may be implemented for the frame **202**. The frame **202** supports a glazing unit **210**, which may be any of a variety of configurations. As shown, the fenestration unit **200** is configured as a fixed window, but any of a variety of configurations (casement, single hung, double hung, awning or other) are also contemplated.

[0146] As shown in FIGS. **13** and **14**, the fenestration unit **200** includes one or more installation features that facilitate installation of the fenestration unit **200** in the rough opening. For example, as

shown, the fenestration unit **200** may include one or more of the following installation features: a mounting bracket system **212** (also described as an engagement system), a retention system including an installation stabilizer system **214** (FIG. **13**) and a sill spacer system **216** (FIG. **14**), a weather seal system **218**. The components and systems of the fenestration unit **200** may be substantially similar to the corresponding components and systems of the fenestration unit **100**, except as described below.

[0147] With continued reference to FIGS. **13** and **14** and additional reference to FIGS. **15-18**, the mounting bracket system **212** generally includes a plurality of mounting brackets **220** that are couplable to the outer perimeter **204** of the frame **202**. The mounting brackets **220** may each be substantially similar to one another and may be described cumulatively in association with a first one of the mounting brackets **220**, an example of which (a first mounting bracket **220a**) is depicted in FIGS. **15-18**.

[0148] As shown in FIGS. **15-18**, the first mounting bracket **220a** generally includes a first leg **222** and a second leg **224**. The first leg **222** and the second leg **224** may be integrally formed, or monolithically coupled, by fabricating the first mounting bracket **220a** via sheet metal stamping and bending processes. In other embodiments, the first mounting bracket **220a** may be fabricated using other materials and/or processes, and the first leg **222** and the second leg **224** may be coupled in other manners, such as via one or more fasteners (not shown). The first leg **222** of the first mounting bracket **220a** includes one or more first feet **226** (illustratively one first foot **226**) and one or more second feet **228** (illustratively one second foot **228**) that are generally disposed apart from the second leg **224**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, each first foot **226** includes an ankle portion **227** and an angled toe portion **229** coupled to the ankle portion **227**. Similarly, in some embodiments and as illustrated, each second foot **228** includes an ankle portion **231** and an angled toe portion **233** coupled to the ankle portion **231**. In some embodiments, guides **225** may be disposed on one or both sides of the second foot **228**, and the guides **225** may contact the interior face **206** of the frame **202** to facilitate securing the mounting bracket **220a** to the frame **202**.

[0149] The first foot **226** and the second foot **228** are received in channels formed on the frame **202** to secure the first mounting bracket **220a** to the frame **202**. More specifically and referring to FIG. **16**, the first foot **226**, specifically the angled toe portion **229**, is received in a first channel **230**, more specifically an installation fin channel **230** formed on the perimeter **204** of the frame **202**, and the second foot **228**, specifically the angled toe portion **233**, is received in a second channel **232**, more specifically an accessory channel **232** formed on the interior face **206** of the frame **202**.

Illustratively, the first channel **230** and the second channel **232** face substantially perpendicularly relative to each other, and the first foot **226** and the second foot **228** accordingly may face toward each other to facilitate receipt in the first channel **230** and the second channel **232**, respectively. In other embodiments, the first foot **226** and the second foot **228** may have different arrangements depending on the arrangement of the first channel **230** and the second channel **232**. The first foot **226** and the second foot **228** and/or the portions of the frame **202** adjacent to the first channel **230** and the second channel **232** may be sufficiently flexible to facilitate bending and receiving the feet **226**, **228** in the channels **230**, **232** when coupling the mounting bracket **220a** to the frame **202**. In some embodiments, the mounting bracket **220a** is coupled to the frame **202** by camming, or rotating, the bracket **220a** relative to the frame **200**. More specifically, the first foot **226** is inserted into the first channel **230**, then the second foot **228** is inserted into the second channel **232**. In some embodiments, the second foot **228** is driven into the second channel **232** by applying additional force to the mounting bracket **220a** (e.g., by pressing on the mounting bracket **220a** by hand, striking the mounting bracket **220a** with a mallet, or the like). In other embodiments, the mounting brackets **220** may be coupled to the frame **202** in additional or other manners, such as via fasteners, more specifically screws or rivets, or adhesives, such as very high bond (VHB) tape.

[0150] Referring specifically to FIG. **16**, the mounting brackets **220** may be sized to provide an intended depth for installation. More specifically, the length of the mounting brackets **220** between

the rear edge of a fin assembly **235** of the weather seal system **218** (in its unconstrained or deployed configuration, shown in phantom lines, as described in further detail below) and the second legs **224** may be sized to provide the intended depth D2 for installation. The length of the mounting brackets **220** may provide an intended installation depth D2, e.g., in a range of 3.750 in. to 4.125 in., a range of 3.750 in. to 4.125 in. for a 2×4 wall, a range of 5.750 in. to 6.125 in. for a 2×6 wall, or larger ranges for larger walls.

[0151] In some embodiments, the weather seal system **218** facilitates coupling the mounting brackets **220** to the frame **202** at specific positions. More specifically, the fin assembly **235** of the weather seal system **218** may occupy the first channel **230** at various positions along the frame **202** and thereby inhibit the mounting brackets **220** from coupling to the frame **202** at those positions. In contrast, the fin assembly **235** may be notched, punched, or otherwise absent from the first channel **230** at various positions along the frame **202** (for example, the position shown in FIG. 16) and thereby permit the mounting brackets **220** to couple to the frame **202** at those positions.

[0152] With reference again to FIGS. 15-18, the second leg **224** of the first mounting bracket **220a** extends approximately perpendicularly from the first leg **222** and outward relative to the frame **202**. The second leg **224** is configured to abut the interior face of the rough opening framing and thereby properly position the fenestration unit **200** in the rough opening. The second leg **224** includes one or more apertures **234** (illustratively, two apertures **234**), and each aperture **234** is configured to receive a fastener (not shown) for securing the fenestration unit **200** to the rough opening framing. The apertures **234** may be recessed or countersunk to permit screw heads to be mounted flush.

[0153] With reference to FIGS. 19-22, the installation stabilizer system **214** includes one or more retainers **236**, also described as stabilizer clips **236**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the installation stabilizer system **214** includes one retainer **236**. Generally, the retainer **236** is configured to permit insertion of the frame **202** within the rough opening in a first insertion direction D1 (FIG. 20) and resist extraction of the frame **202** from the rough opening in a second extraction direction D2 (FIG. 20). The retainer **236** includes a base **238** configured to be secured to the frame **202** (FIGS. 19 and 20), and one or more flex arms **240** extending from the base **238**. Each flex arm **240** includes one or more engagement features **242** (FIGS. 21 and 22) at a terminal end. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the engagement features **242** are generally rectangular teeth-like structures that are configured to “bite” into the rough opening framing. In some embodiments and as illustrated, one or more of the flex arms **240** may have a different length and/or extend from the base **238** at a different position than other flex arms **240**. For example and as illustrated in FIGS. 21 and 22, the retainer **236** includes a first flex arm **240a** extending from a first side of the base **238**, a second flex arm **240b** extending from a second side of the base **238**, and a third flex arm **240c** generally disposed between the first flex arm **240a** and the second flex arm **240b**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the first flex arm **240a** has a first length, the second flex arm **240b** has a second length less than the first length, and the third flex arm **240c** has a third length less than the second length. In some embodiments, the different lengths of the flex arms **240** advantageously permit the fenestration unit **200** to be installed in rough openings of various sizes, in particular rough openings that provide different gap sizes between the head of the frame **202** and the rough opening framing. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the third flex arm **240c** extends from the base **238** at a position that is horizontally offset (e.g., as shown in FIG. 20) from a position on the base **238** from which the first flex arm **240a** and the second flex arm **240b** extend. In certain embodiments, this arrangement of the flex arms **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** advantageously inhibits the relatively long arms (that is, the first flex arm **240a** and the second flex arm **240b**) from extending past the interior face **206** of the frame **202** (shown elsewhere) when positioned in the rough opening. In some embodiments, all of the flex arms **240** may have the same length and/or extend from the base **238** at the same position. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the flex arms **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** extend from the base **238** at the same angle. In some embodiments, the flex arms **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** extend from the base **238** different angles, or are otherwise

structured to provide the flex arms **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** with different heights relative to the base **238**. Stated another way, in some embodiments the first flex arm **240a** has a first height relative to the base **238**, the second flex arm **240b** has a second height relative to the base **238** less than the first height, and the third flex arm **240c** has a third height relative to the base **238** less than the second height.

[0154] In some embodiments, the base **238** includes one or more first feet **244** (illustratively one first foot **244**) and one or more second feet **246** (illustratively one second foot **246**) for securing the retainer **236** to the frame **202**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, each first foot **244** includes an ankle portion **245** and an angled toe portion **247** coupled to the ankle portion **245**. Similarly, in some embodiments and as illustrated, each second foot **246** includes an ankle portion **249** and an angled toe portion **251** coupled to the ankle portion **247**.

[0155] The first foot **244**, specifically the angled toe portion **247**, is received in the first channel **230** (FIG. **20**) formed on the perimeter **204** of the frame **202** and the second foot **246**, specifically the angled toe portion **251** is received in the second channel **232** (FIG. **20**) formed on the interior face **206** of the frame **202**. Illustratively, the first channel **230** and the second channel **232** face substantially perpendicularly relative to each other, and the first foot **244** and the second foot **246** accordingly may face toward each other to facilitate receipt in the first channel **230** and the second channel **232**, respectively. In other embodiments, the first foot **244** and the second foot **246** may have different arrangements depending on the arrangement of the first channel **230** and the second channel **232**. The first foot **244** and the second foot **246** and/or the portions of the frame **202** adjacent to the first channel **230** and the second channel **232** may be sufficiently flexible to facilitate bending and receiving the feet **244**, **246** in the channels **230**, **232** when coupling the retainer **236** to the frame **202**. In some embodiments, the retainer **236** is coupled to the frame **202** by camming, or rotating, the retainer **236** relative to the frame **202**. More specifically, the first foot **244** is inserted into the first channel **230**, then the second foot **246** is inserted into the second channel **232**. In some embodiments, the second foot **246** is driven into the second channel **232** by applying additional force to the retainer **236** (e.g., by pressing on the retainer **236** by hand, striking the retainer **236** with a mallet, or the like).

[0156] During insertion of the frame **202** in the first insertion direction **D1** (FIG. **20**), one or more of the flex arms **240** of the retainer **236** (e.g., the longest flex arm **240** if a large gap is present between the frame **202** and the rough opening framing or all of the flex arms **240** if a small gap is present) bends or is deflected in a first flex direction. The insertion force, or force required to move the unit **200** in the first direction **D1** may be, for example, 1 lb. or less, more than 1 lb, more than 10 lbs, or more than 15 lbs. Upon application of a force on the frame **202** in the second extraction direction **D2**, the flex arm **240** bends in a second flex direction to resist movement of the frame **202** in the second direction **D2** (e.g., toward the interior side). The extraction or tipping force, or force required to move the unit **200** in the second direction **D2** after seating may be greater than the insertion force. The extraction force may be, for example, 1 lb. or less, more than 1 lb, 10 lbs or more, at least 15 lbs, or 15 lbs or more. In some examples, the extraction force is 80 lbs or more, or approximately 88 lbs. Generally, a higher extraction or tipping force (e.g., as compared to the insertion force) helps ensure the fenestration unit **200** remains in place after being inserted into the rough opening to permit subsequent levelling and/or securement procedures.

[0157] Installation of the fenestration unit **200** in the rough opening may proceed in a substantially manner as the fenestration unit **100**, as described above.

[0158] FIGS. **23-26** illustrate a fenestration unit **300**, or components thereof, according to some embodiments. The components of the fenestration unit **300** may be substantially similar to the corresponding components and systems of the fenestration unit **200**, except as described below. The fenestration unit **300** includes a frame **302** having an outer perimeter **304**, and a mounting bracket system **306** couples to the frame **302** via a first channel **308**, more specifically a “T-slot” or undercut channel **308**, formed in the perimeter **304** of the frame **302**. The mounting bracket system

306 includes one or more mounting brackets. The mounting brackets may each be substantially similar to one another and may be described cumulatively in association with a first one of the mounting brackets, an example of which (a first mounting bracket **310a**) is depicted in FIGS. **23** and **24**.

[0159] The first mounting bracket **310a** generally includes a first leg **312** and a second leg **314**. The first leg **312** and the second leg **314** may be integrally formed, or monolithically coupled, by fabricating the first mounting bracket **310a** via sheet metal stamping and bending processes. In other embodiments, the first mounting bracket **310a** may be fabricated using other materials and/or processes, and the first leg **312** and the second leg **314** may be coupled in other manners, such as via one or more fasteners (not shown). The first leg **312** of the first mounting bracket **310a** includes a pivotable or rotatable interlocking cam **316** that is positionable in the channel **308** on the perimeter **304** of the frame **302**. In an initial, or unlocked configuration shown in FIG. **25**, the cam **316** is disposed apart from sidewalls **318** of the channel **308** and thereby insertable in the channel **308**. The cam **316** is then pivoted to a locked configuration as shown in FIG. **26**, and feet **320** of the cam **316** are positioned in an undercut portion **322** (FIG. **23**) of the channel **308** and behind the sidewalls **318** of the channel **308**. This action secures the cam **316**, and thereby the mounting bracket **310**, to the frame **302**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the cam **316** includes a slot **321** for receiving a tool (for example, a flat-head screwdriver; alternatively, a Phillips-head screwdriver, a star-head screwdriver driver, or the like) to facilitate pivoting the cam **316**. In some embodiments, the cam **316** lacks a slot and is shaped or otherwise configured to be pivoted by a different tool, such as a wrench or the like.

[0160] With reference again to FIGS. **23** and **24**, the second leg **314** of the first mounting bracket **310a** extends approximately perpendicularly from the first leg **312** and outward relative to the frame **302**. The second leg **314** is configured to abut an interior face of rough opening framing and thereby properly position the fenestration unit **300** in the rough opening. The second leg **314** includes one or more apertures **324** (illustratively, two apertures **324**), and each aperture **324** is configured to receive a fastener (not shown) for securing the fenestration unit **300** to the rough opening framing. The apertures **324** may be recessed or countersunk to permit screw heads to be mounted flush.

[0161] Except for the actions for securing the cam **316** in the channel **308** of the frame **302**, installation of the fenestration unit **300** in the rough opening may proceed in a substantially manner as the fenestration unit **100**, as described above.

[0162] FIG. **27** illustrates a fenestration unit **400**, according to some embodiments, where the view is a top-oriented perspective view from the interior side of a building or wall. FIG. **27** illustrates the fenestration unit **400** in an installing configuration in which the unit **400** is configured for positioning in a rough opening defined by rough opening framing (shown elsewhere) of the building or wall. The fenestration unit **400** is also configurable in an initial or pre-installation configuration (e.g., as initially received by an installer) and a final, installed configuration, or installation configuration (e.g., secured in the rough opening).

[0163] The fenestration unit **400** generally includes a frame **402** having an outer perimeter **404**, a front or interior face (not shown), as well as a back or exterior face (not shown). The frame **402** may be constructed of vinyl, fiberglass, or other materials. The frame **402** supports a glazing unit **405**, which may be any of a variety of configurations. As shown, the fenestration unit **400** is configured as a fixed window, but any of a variety of configurations (casement, single hung, double hung, awning or other) are also contemplated.

[0164] The fenestration unit **400** includes one or more installation features that facilitate installation of the fenestration unit **400** in the rough opening. For example, as shown, the fenestration unit **400** may include one or more of the following installation features: a mounting bracket system **406** (also described as an engagement system), a retention system including an installation stabilizer system (not shown) and a sill spacer system (not shown), and a weather seal

system (not shown). The retention system and the weather seal system of the fenestration unit **400** may be substantially similar to the corresponding systems of any of the other fenestration units contemplated herein, such as the fenestration unit **100** or the fenestration unit **200**. The mounting bracket system **406** may be as described below.

[0165] With continued reference to FIG. **27**, the mounting bracket system **406** generally includes one or more mounting brackets **408** that are couplable to the frame **402**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the mounting bracket system **406** includes one mounting bracket **408**. The mounting bracket **408** includes a base **410** that extends around the entire perimeter of the glazing unit **405**. The base **410** detachably couples to the frame **402**, for example, by including one or more legs (not shown) that are received in one or more channels of the frame **402**, the channels being, for example, similar to the channel **146** formed on the perimeter **120** of the frame **110** (FIG. **4**) or the accessory channel **232** formed on the interior face **206** of the frame **202** (FIG. **16**). The base **410** couples to a plurality of second legs **412** configured to abut the rough opening framing and receive fasteners (not shown) for securing the fenestration unit **400** to the rough opening framing. In other embodiments, the mounting bracket system **406** includes a plurality of mounting brackets **408**, and each bracket **408** extends along a portion of the perimeter of the glazing unit **405** and includes one or more second legs **412** configured to abut the rough opening framing and receive fasteners (not shown) for securing the fenestration unit **400** to the rough opening framing.

[0166] Alternatively, the second legs **412** may be part of or form a fin that is integrally coupled to the frame **402** at or near the interior side. In such embodiments, the fin may initially extend around additional portions or the entirety of the perimeter of the frame **402**, and various portions of the fin may then be removed to form the second legs **412** at specific locations.

[0167] Fenestration units according to some embodiments of the present disclosure may be installed in newly constructed buildings or walls. Fenestration units according to some embodiments may alternatively be installed to retrofit previously constructed buildings or walls. FIG. **28** illustrates a fenestration unit **500**, according to some embodiments, where the view is a side sectional view of the unit **500** and rough opening framing **16** and an interior wall covering **20** (e.g., drywall) of a building or wall. The fenestration unit **500** includes a frame **502** that may be substantially similar to any of the frames contemplated herein. The fenestration unit **500** also includes one or more installation features that facilitate installation of the fenestration unit **500** in the rough opening **14** of the building or wall. For example, the fenestration unit **500** may include one or more of the following installation features: a mounting bracket system **504** (also described as a frame or jamb extension), a retention system including an installation stabilizer system (not shown) and a sill spacer system (not shown), and a weather seal system (not shown). The retention system and the weather seal system of the fenestration unit **500** may be substantially similar to the corresponding systems of any of the other fenestration units contemplated herein, such as the fenestration unit **100** or the fenestration unit **200**. The mounting bracket system **504** may be as described below.

[0168] With continued reference to FIG. **28**, the jamb extension **504** generally includes one or more extenders **506** that are couplable to the frame **502**. Each extender **506** may be functionally similar to any of the mounting brackets contemplated herein and may have various widths to accommodate different wall depths, such as 2×4 and 2×6 constructions. For example, each extender **506** includes a first leg **508** that is received in a channel **510** on the interior face of the frame **502** to detachably couple the extender **506** to the frame **502**, and each extender **506** includes a second leg **509** that receives one or more fasteners **512** for securing the extender **506** to the rough opening framing **16**. Additionally, each extender **506** includes a mounting flange **514** adjacent the second leg **509** for positioning, in a new constructed situation, the interior wall covering **20**. In a retrofitting situation, the fasteners **512** may extend through both the interior wall covering **20** and the second leg **509** of each mounting bracket to secure the fenestration unit **500** to the rough opening framing **16**.

[0169] FIG. **29** illustrates a jamb extension **600**, according to some embodiments, where the view

is a side sectional view of the extension **600** and an interior wall covering **20** (e.g., drywall) of a building or wall. The extension **600** may form part of the fenestration unit **500** (FIG. **28**) instead of the extension **506**. The extension **600** is substantially similar to the extension **506**, except that the extension **600** includes a curved or rounded profile **602**, to provide a “bullnose” aesthetic, opposite the mounting flange **604** and the interior wall covering **20**.

[0170] FIGS. **30** and **31** illustrate a fenestration unit **700**, according to some embodiments, where FIG. **30** is a bottom-oriented perspective view from the interior side of a building or wall and FIG. **31** is a side sectional view. The fenestration unit **700** is illustrated in an installing configuration in which the unit **700** is configured for positioning in a rough opening defined by rough opening framing (shown elsewhere) of the building or wall. The fenestration unit **700** is also configurable in an initial or pre-installation configuration (e.g., as initially received by an installer) and a final, installed configuration, or installation configuration (e.g., secured in the rough opening).

[0171] The fenestration unit **700** generally includes a frame **702** having an outer perimeter **704**, a front or interior face **706**, as well as a back or exterior face (not shown). The frame **702** may be constructed of vinyl, fiberglass, or other materials. The frame **702** supports a glazing unit **708**, which may be any of a variety of configurations. As shown, the fenestration unit **700** is configured as a fixed window, but any of a variety of configurations (casement, single hung, double hung, awning or other) are also contemplated.

[0172] The fenestration unit **700** includes one or more installation features that facilitate installation of the fenestration unit **700** in the rough opening. For example, as shown, the fenestration unit **700** may include one or more of the following installation features: a mounting bracket system (not shown, but may be substantially similar to any of the mounting bracket systems described herein, such as the mounting bracket system **128** or the mounting bracket system **212**—also described as an engagement system), a retention system including an installation stabilizer system (not shown, but may be substantially similar to any of the stabilizer systems described herein, such as the stabilizer system **130** or the stabilizer system **214**) and a sill spacer system **710**, and a weather seal system (not shown, but may be substantially similar to any of the weather seal systems described herein, such as the weather seal system **134** or the weather seal system **218**). The mounting bracket system, the installation stabilizer system, and the weather seal system of the fenestration unit **700** may be substantially similar to the corresponding systems of any of the other fenestration units contemplated herein, such as the fenestration unit **100** or the fenestration unit **200**. The sill spacer system **710** may be as described below.

[0173] With continued reference to FIG. **30** and additional reference to FIG. **31**, the sill spacer system **710** includes one or more sill spacers **712**, such as a pair of sill spacers **712**, that are selectively attachable to and detachable from the bottom of the frame **702**. In some embodiments, the sill spacers **712** may be detached from the frame **702** in the pre-installation configuration (i.e., the sill spacers **712** may be initially provided to an installer or installers detached from the frame **702**). In other embodiments, the sill spacers **712** may be coupled to the frame **702** in the pre-installation configuration (i.e., the sill spacers **712** may be initially provided to an installer or installers coupled to the frame **702**).

[0174] In some embodiments, the sill spacer system **710** provides a convenient mechanism for positioning and leveling the fenestration unit **700** inside the rough opening (shown elsewhere). In some embodiments, the sill spacer system **710** facilitates centering the fenestration unit **700** within the rough opening by reducing friction between the frame **702** of the fenestration unit **700** and the rough opening framing as they move against each other. The sill spacer system **710** establishes a gap between the rough opening and the bottom of the frame **702** to make it easier for an installer to adjust the position of the fenestration unit **700** (e.g., insert a pry bar or other tool under the sill of the fenestration unit **700** for lifting and leveling). One or more shims, such as standard wood shims, can be slid under the sill spacer system **710** and/or otherwise under the fenestration unit **700** for leveling the fenestration unit **700** within the rough opening.

[0175] With specific reference to FIG. 31, each sill spacer **712** may include one or more legs (illustratively, a first leg **714** and a second leg **716**) that are positioned in channels (illustratively, a first channel **718** and a second channel **720**) formed on the perimeter **704** on the frame **702** for coupling the spacer **712** to the frame **702**. More specifically, the legs **714** and **716** and channels **718** and **720** facilitate snap fitting the sill spacer **712** to the frame **702**. Each sill spacer **712** may also include a handle **722** that facilitates attaching and detaching the spacer **712** from the frame **702**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the handle **722** extends in an interior direction and opposite the first leg **714**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the handle **722** is integrally formed with the remainder of the sill spacer **712**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, each sill spacer **712** includes a rounded lower contact surface **724**. Each sill spacer **712** may additionally include any of the features of the sill spacers described in U.S. Application No. 18/478, 189, filed Sep. 29, 2023, previously incorporated by reference.

[0176] FIGS. 32 and 33 illustrate a fenestration unit **800**, according to some embodiments, where FIG. 32 is a bottom-oriented perspective view from the interior side of a building or wall and FIG. 33 is a side sectional view. The fenestration unit **800** is illustrated in an installing configuration in which the unit **800** is configured for positioning in a rough opening defined by rough opening framing (shown elsewhere) of the building or wall. The fenestration unit **800** is also configurable in an initial or pre-installation configuration (e.g., as initially received by an installer) and a final, installed configuration, or installation configuration (e.g., secured in the rough opening).

[0177] The fenestration unit **800** generally includes a frame **802** having an outer perimeter **804**, a front or interior face **806**, as well as a back or exterior face (not shown). The frame **802** may be constructed of vinyl, fiberglass, or other materials. The frame **802** supports a glazing unit **808**, which may be any of a variety of configurations. As shown, the fenestration unit **800** is configured as a fixed window, but any of a variety of configurations (casement, single hung, double hung, awning or other) are also contemplated.

[0178] The fenestration unit **800** includes one or more installation features that facilitate installation of the fenestration unit **800** in the rough opening. For example, as shown, the fenestration unit **800** may include one or more of the following installation features: a mounting bracket system (not shown, but may be substantially similar to any of the mounting bracket systems described herein, such as the mounting bracket system **128** or the mounting bracket system **212**—also described as an engagement system), a retention system including an installation stabilizer system (not shown, but may be substantially similar to any of the stabilizer systems described herein, such as the stabilizer system **130** or the stabilizer system **214**) and a sill spacer system **810**, and a weather seal system (not shown, but may be substantially similar to any of the weather seal systems described herein, such as the weather seal system **134** or the weather seal system **218**). The mounting bracket system, the installation stabilizer system, and the weather seal system of the fenestration unit **800** may be substantially similar to the corresponding systems of any of the other fenestration units contemplated herein, such as the fenestration unit **100** or the fenestration unit **200**. The sill spacer system **810** may be as described below.

[0179] With continued reference to FIG. 32 and additional reference to FIG. 33, the sill spacer system **810** includes one or more sill spacers **812**, such as a pair of sill spacers **812**, that are selectively attachable to and detachable from the bottom of the frame **802**. In some embodiments, the sill spacers **812** may be detached from the frame **802** in the pre-installation configuration (i.e., the sill spacers **812** may be initially provided to an installer or installers detached from the frame **802**). In other embodiments, the sill spacers **812** may be coupled to the frame **802** in the pre-installation configuration (i.e., the sill spacers **812** may be initially provided to an installer or installers coupled to the frame **802**).

[0180] In some embodiments, the sill spacer system **810** provides a convenient mechanism for positioning and leveling the fenestration unit **800** inside the rough opening (shown elsewhere). In some embodiments, the sill spacer system **810** facilitates centering the fenestration unit **800** within

the rough opening by reducing friction between the frame **802** of the fenestration unit **800** and the rough opening framing as they move against each other. The sill spacer system **810** establishes a gap between the rough opening and the bottom of the frame **802** to make it easier for an installer to adjust the position of the fenestration unit **800** (e.g., insert a pry bar or other tool under the sill of the fenestration unit **800** for lifting and leveling). One or more shims, such as standard wood shims, can be slid under the sill spacer system **810** and/or otherwise under the fenestration unit **800** for leveling the fenestration unit **800** within the rough opening.

[0181] With specific reference to FIG. **33**, each sill spacer **812** may include one or more legs (illustratively, a first leg **814** and a second leg **816**) that are positioned in channels (illustratively, a first channel **818** and a second channel **820**) formed on the perimeter **804** on the frame **802** for coupling the spacer **812** to the frame **802**. Each sill spacer **812** may also include a handle **822** that facilitates attaching and detaching the spacer **812** from the frame **802**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, each sill spacer **812** includes a flat lower contact surface **824** or is substantially rectangular. Each sill spacer **812** may additionally include any of the features of the sill spacers described in U.S. Application No. 18/478, 189, filed Sep. 29, 2023, previously incorporated by reference.

[0182] In other embodiments, the first channel **818** and the second channel **820** are recessed in the frame **802**, and a force pushing the frame **802** toward the spacer(s) **812** pushes the legs **814**, **816** of the spacer(s) **812** into the channels **818**, **820**, respectively, in contrast to potentially moving the legs **814**, **816** apart. This arrangement provides further positive engagement of the spacer(s) **812** for relatively heavy units and nevertheless permits easy insertion and removal of the spacer(s) **812** from the frame **802**.

[0183] FIGS. **34-36** illustrate a fenestration unit **900**, according to some embodiments, where FIGS. **34** and **35** are perspective views from the interior side of a building or wall and FIG. **36** is a detail side view. FIGS. **34-36** illustrate the fenestration unit **900** in an installed configuration, or installation configuration (e.g., secured in a rough opening defined by rough opening framing of a building or a wall—rough opening shown elsewhere). The fenestration unit **900** is also configurable in an initial or pre-installation configuration (e.g., as initially received by an installer) and an installing configuration in which the unit **900** is configured for positioning in the rough opening.

[0184] The fenestration unit **900** generally includes a frame **902** having an outer perimeter **904**, a front or interior face **906**, as well as a back or exterior face (not shown). As illustrated, the frame **902** may be a fiberglass frame design. However, vinyl, wood, or other materials may be implemented for the frame **902**. The frame **902** supports one or more glazing units **910** (FIGS. **34** and **35**), which may be any of a variety of configurations. As shown, the fenestration unit **900** is configured as a double hung window, but any of a variety of configurations (fixed, single hung, casement, awning or other) are also contemplated.

[0185] As shown in FIGS. **34-36**, the fenestration unit **900** includes one or more installation features that facilitate installation of the fenestration unit **900** in the rough opening. For example, as shown, the fenestration unit **900** may include one or more of the following installation features: a mounting bracket system **912** (also described as an engagement system), a retention system including an installation stabilizer system **914** and a sill spacer system **915** (FIG. **35**), a weather seal system **916**. The sill spacer system **915** and the weather seal system **916** of the fenestration unit **900** may be substantially similar to the corresponding systems of any of the other fenestration units contemplated herein, such as the fenestration unit **100** or the fenestration unit **200**. The mounting bracket system **912** and the stabilizer system **914** may be as described below.

[0186] With continued reference to FIGS. **34-36**, the mounting bracket system **912** generally includes a plurality of mounting brackets **918**, also referred to as gaging brackets **918**, that are couplable to the outer perimeter **904** of the frame **902** and gauged to the interior surface of the rough opening, detachable from the frame **902** after mounting the unit **900** in the rough opening,

and is optionally reusable with the same, or a different fenestration unit. In some embodiments, the mounting brackets **918** are detached from the frame **902** in the pre-installation configuration. In other embodiments, the mounting brackets **918** are coupled to the frame **902** in the pre-installation configuration. The mounting brackets **918** may each be substantially similar to one another and may be described cumulatively in association with a first one of the mounting brackets **918**, an example of which (a first mounting bracket **918a**) is depicted in FIGS. **37-40**.

[0187] As shown in FIGS. **37-40**, the first mounting bracket **918a** generally includes a first leg **920** and a second leg **922**. The first leg **920** and the second leg **922** may be integrally formed, or monolithically coupled, via an injection molding process. In other embodiments, the first leg **920** and the second leg **922** may be manufactured using a different process, and the first leg **920** and the second leg **922** may be coupled in other manners, such as via one or more fasteners (not shown). In some embodiments, the first leg **920** and the second leg **922** may be relatively movable/adjustable to facilitate use of the first mounting bracket **918a** when installing fenestration units in walls of various depths (for example, from about 3 inches to 12 inches). The first leg **920** of the first mounting bracket **918a** includes one or more feet, illustratively a first or stationary foot **924** and a second or movable foot **926** that are generally disposed apart from the second leg **922**. The first foot **924** and the second foot **926** are received in a channel formed on the frame **902** (FIG. **36**) to secure the first mounting bracket **918a** to the frame **902**. More specifically and referring to FIGS. **39** and **40**, the first foot **924** is positioned in an interior accessory channel **928** of the frame **902** by abutting the first mounting bracket **918a** against the frame **902**, and then the second foot **926** is moved from a retracted configuration (FIG. **39**) to an extended configuration (FIG. **40**) and into the channel **928**. The feet **924**, **926** thereby substantially occupy the entire cross-sectional area of the channel **928** and inhibit unintended detachment of the first mounting bracket **918a** from the frame **902**.

[0188] With specific reference to FIG. **38**, in some embodiments the first mounting bracket **918a** includes an actuator, more specifically a pivotable lever **930**, for moving the second foot **926** from the retracted configuration to the extended configuration and vice versa. The lever **930** pivotably couples to the first leg **920** via a first pivot **931**, and the lever **930** pivotably couples to the second leg **922** via a second pivot **933**. The actuator moves the second foot **926** in a track **935** formed on the first leg **920**. In other embodiments, the first mounting bracket **918a** includes other features for moving the second foot **926** from the retracted configuration to the extended configuration and vice versa.

[0189] With reference again to FIGS. **37** and **38**, the second leg **922** of the first mounting bracket **918a** extends approximately perpendicularly from the first leg **920**. The second leg **922** is configured to abut the interior face of the rough opening framing and thereby properly position the fenestration unit **900** in the rough opening. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the second leg **922** lacks apertures for receiving fasteners and securing the fenestration unit **900** to the rough opening framing. In other embodiments, the second leg **922** includes one or more apertures (not shown) for receiving fasteners and securing the fenestration unit **900** to the rough opening framing.

[0190] With reference to FIGS. **36** and **37**, the installation stabilizer system **914** includes one or more retainers **932**, also described as stabilizer clips **932**. In some embodiments and as illustrated, the installation stabilizer system **914** includes one or more retainers **932** each coupled to one of the mounting brackets **918**, including the first mounting bracket **918a**. The retainers **932** may each be substantially similar to one another and may be described cumulatively in association with a first one of the retainers **932**, an example of which (a first retainer **932a**) is depicted in FIG. **37**.

Generally, the retainer **932a** is configured to permit insertion of the frame **902** within the rough opening in a first insertion direction and resist extraction of the frame **902** from the rough opening in a second extraction direction. The retainer **932a** may be substantially similar to any of the other retainers contemplated herein, including those of the fenestration unit **100** and the fenestration unit **200**.

[0191] With reference again to FIGS. 34-36, the mounting bracket system **912** also includes one or more coupling brackets **934** for securing the fenestration unit **900** to the rough opening framing. In some embodiments, the coupling brackets **934** are detached from the frame **902** (e.g., being supplied in associated packaging and/or as a kit including a plurality of differently sized brackets) in the pre-installation configuration. In other embodiments, the coupling brackets **934** are coupled to the frame **902** in the pre-installation configuration. Illustratively, the mounting bracket system **912** includes seven coupling brackets **934**, with three coupling brackets **934** disposed on the left side of the frame **902**, three coupling brackets **934** disposed on the right side of the frame **902**, and one coupling bracket **934** disposed on the top of the frame **902**. The coupling brackets **934** may each be substantially similar to one another and may be described cumulatively in association with a first one of the coupling brackets **934**, an example of which (a first coupling bracket **934a**) is depicted in FIGS. 41 and 42.

[0192] As shown in FIGS. 41-44, the first coupling bracket **934a** generally includes a base **936**, one or more first feet **938** (illustratively, one first foot **938**), and one or more second feet **940** (illustratively, two second feet **940**). The base **936**, the first foot **938**, and the second feet **940** may be integrally formed, or monolithically coupled, by fabricating the first coupling bracket **934a** via sheet metal stamping and bending processes. In other embodiments, the first coupling bracket **934a** may be fabricated using other materials and/or processes. The first foot **938** and the second feet **940** are received in channels formed on the frame **902** to secure the first coupling bracket **934a** to the frame **902**. More specifically, the first foot **938** is received in an installation fin channel (not shown) formed on the perimeter **904** of the frame **902**, and the second feet **940** is received in the interior accessory channel **928** of the frame **902**. Illustratively, the first foot **938** and the second feet **940** face toward each other to facilitate receipt in the installation fin channel and the interior accessory channel **928**, respectively. In other embodiments, the first foot **938** and the second feet **940** may have different arrangements. The first foot **938** and the second feet **940** and/or the portions of the frame **902** adjacent to the channels may be sufficiently flexible to facilitate bending and receiving the feet **938**, **940** in the channels when coupling the coupling bracket **934a** to the frame **902**. In some embodiments, the first coupling bracket **934a** is coupled to the frame **902** by camming, or rotating, the first coupling bracket **934a** relative to the frame **902**. More specifically, the second foot **940** is inserted into a channel of the frame **902**, and then the first foot **938** is inserted into a channel of the frame **902**.

[0193] In some embodiments, the first foot **938** is driven into the channel by applying additional force to the first coupling bracket **934a** (e.g., by pressing on the first coupling bracket **934a** by hand, striking the first coupling bracket **934a** with a mallet, or the like). The base **936** of the coupling bracket **934a** includes one or more apertures **942** (illustratively, countersink apertures) for receiving fasteners and thereby securing the fenestration unit **900** to the rough opening framing. In some embodiments, the aperture **942** acts as a centering guide for the coupling bracket **934a**, as a means to easily locate the center of the aperture **942** and hold the bracket **934a** stationary when driving fasteners through the aperture **942**. In some embodiments, the outer surface **943** of the coupling bracket **934a** (that is, the surface of the base **936** opposite the first foot **938** and the second feet **940**) includes a double taper. Stated another way, a central portion **945** of the outer surface **943** is disposed further from the first foot **938** and the second feet **940** than an upper end **947** and a lower end **949** of the outer surface **943**. In certain embodiments, the double taper advantageously permits a shim **950** to be inserted between the bracket **934a** and the rough opening framing **951** from either the upper end **947** (as shown in FIG. 44) or the lower end **949**. If a shim is installed from the upper end **947** (as shown in FIG. 44), gravity advantageously facilitates moving the shim between the bracket **934a** and the rough opening framing. Relatedly, the double taper advantageously permits use of full-length shims; in contrast, horizontally-inserted shims have a limited insertion depth based on the depth of the unit (for example, about 2 inches) or are shortened to avoid interfering with other components. Relatedly, the double taper advantageously permits the

shim to provide even pressure over half of the outer surface **943** of the bracket **934a**, in contrast to a line load, and rotating of the bracket **934a** when a fastener is driven into the aperture **942**. Further relatedly, the double taper also permits the bracket **934a** to act as a universal piece that can be used on either jamb (that is, the bracket **934a** is not specifically right-handed or left-handed), and gravity advantageously facilitates positioning shims in both situations and orientations. Even further relatedly, the double taper advantageously reduces installation time, facilitates easy and more consistent adjustments, and reduces or eliminates rotation of the bracket **934a** and unit movement when the fastener is driven through the aperture **942**.

[0194] Advantageously, the coupling brackets **934** may have the same sizes and/or arrangements for fenestration units and rough openings of various sizes.

[0195] Installation of the fenestration unit **900** in the rough opening may proceed in a substantially manner as the fenestration unit **100**, as described above, except that, and as shown in FIG. **45**, (A) shims **944**, such as standard wood shims, can be slid between the coupling brackets **934** and the rough opening framing **16** to center and tighten the fenestration unit **900** within the rough opening **14**; (B) fasteners are driven through the apertures **942** of the coupling brackets **934**, through the shims **944**, and into the rough opening framing **16** to secure the fenestration unit **900** to the rough opening framing **16**; and (C) the mounting brackets **918** may then be detached from the frame **902**, for example, by using the actuators **930** to move the second legs **922** to the retracted position (FIG. **39**).

[0196] Various advantages may be achieved according to the foregoing example systems and methods. The various examples may be one or more of: more efficient (e.g., cycle time reduced by 50% or more); easier to learn; easier to remember; easier to train; may be less physically demanding (e.g., fenestration units are not set from the exterior side which could be on uneven ground or require a ladder); fenestration units are unable to fall out toward exterior during installation; can be installed by a single person from the interior of the building or wall; interior and exterior installation tasks do not need to be done simultaneously; improved fenestration unit install quality and fenestration unit performance following installation; delivers an installation method that is unique to the industry and offers many benefits for the installer; faster cycle times; improved performance (water and air infiltration); adapts to wall depth variation; simplifies casing installation for finish carpenters; separates interior and exterior work so they can be done “independently”.

[0197] The invention of this application has been described above both generically and with regard to specific embodiments. It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made in the embodiments without departing from the scope of the disclosure. Thus, it is intended that the embodiments cover the modifications and variations of this invention provided they come within the scope of the appended claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A fenestration unit configured for installation in a rough opening in a structure defined by rough opening framing, the rough opening framing having an interior face and an exterior face opposite the interior face, the fenestration unit comprising: a frame comprising a channel; and a plurality of mounting brackets configured to be secured to the frame, the plurality of mounting brackets comprising a first mounting bracket, the first mounting bracket comprising: a first leg comprising a foot configured to be received in the channel to secure the first mounting bracket to the frame; and a second leg coupled to the first leg, the second leg angularly offset from the first leg and configured to abut the interior face of the rough opening framing.
2. The fenestration unit of claim 1, wherein the frame further comprises a sidewall defining the channel, the sidewall comprising a slot, and the foot being received in the slot.
3. The fenestration unit of claim 1, wherein the foot comprises an ankle portion coupled to an

angled toe portion.

4. The fenestration unit of claim 1, further comprising an installation stabilizer system coupled to the frame and operable to exert a retention force on the rough opening framing to maintain positive engagement of the fenestration unit with the rough opening framing and resist extraction of the fenestration unit from the rough opening upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening.

5. The fenestration unit of claim 1, wherein the first leg is integrally formed with the second leg.

6. The fenestration unit of claim 1, wherein the frame further comprises a sill, and further comprising a sill spacer coupled to the sill and configured to abut the rough opening framing.

7. The fenestration unit of claim 1, further comprising a fin assembly coupled to the frame, the fin assembly configured to transition from a first, stowed configuration in which the fin assembly projects in a direction of a front of the frame and a second, deployed configuration in which the fin assembly projects outward relative to the frame.

8. The fenestration unit of claim 1, wherein the frame further comprises an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior surface, the channel being disposed on the perimeter.

9. The fenestration unit of claim 1, wherein the frame further comprises an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior surface, the channel being disposed on the interior surface.

10. The fenestration unit of claim 9, wherein the mounting bracket further comprises an installation stabilizer system operable to exert a retention force on the rough opening framing to maintain positive engagement of the fenestration unit with the rough opening framing and resist extraction of the fenestration unit from the rough opening upon insertion of the fenestration unit in the rough opening.

11. A method of installing a fenestration unit in a rough opening in a structure defined by rough opening framing, the rough opening framing having an interior face and an exterior face opposite the interior face, the method comprising: coupling a first mounting bracket to a frame of the fenestration unit by positioning a foot of a first leg of the first mounting bracket in a channel of the frame; seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening by together translating the frame and the first mounting bracket in an exterior direction within the rough opening until a second leg of the first mounting bracket angularly offset from the first leg is abutted against the interior face of the rough opening framing; and securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the frame further comprises a sidewall defining the channel, the sidewall comprising a slot, and positioning the foot of the first mounting bracket in the channel comprises positioning the foot in the slot.

13. The method of claim 11, wherein seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening further comprises abutting an installation stabilizer system coupled to the fenestration unit against the rough opening framing such that the installation stabilizer system exerts a retention force on the rough opening framing to retain the fenestration unit in the rough opening and prevent tipping of the fenestration unit in an interior direction opposite the exterior direction.

14. The method of claim 11, wherein seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening further comprises abutting a sill spacer coupled to a bottom of the frame against the rough opening framing.

15. The method of claim 11, further comprising deploying a fin assembly coupled to the frame from a first, stowed configuration in which the fin assembly projects in the exterior direction to a second, deployed configuration in which the fin assembly projects outward relative to the frame.

16. The method of claim 11, wherein the second leg comprises an aperture, and wherein securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing comprises inserting a fastener in the aperture.

17. The method of claim 11, wherein the frame further comprises an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior

surface, the channel being disposed on the interior surface.

18. The method of claim 11, wherein the frame further comprises an exterior surface, an interior surface opposite the exterior surface, and a perimeter between the exterior surface and the interior surface, the channel being disposed on the perimeter.

19. The method of claim 11, wherein seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening further comprises abutting an installation stabilizer system coupled to the first mounting bracket against the rough opening framing such that the installation stabilizer system exerts a retention force on the rough opening framing to retain the fenestration unit in the rough opening and prevent tipping of the fenestration unit in an interior direction opposite the exterior direction.

20. The method of claim 11, further comprising, after seating the fenestration unit in the rough opening, abutting the first mounting bracket against the interior face of the rough opening framing, and securing the fenestration unit to the rough opening framing, detaching the first mounting bracket from the frame.
